

ELBOW SPECIAL TESTS

I. TESTS FOR LATERAL EPICONDYLITIS (TENNIS ELBOW)

1. COZEN'S TEST

Purpose

To assess lateral epicondylitis (Tennis Elbow).

Procedure

- Patient makes a fist.
- Elbow flexed to 90°.
- Forearm pronated.
- Wrist extended and radially deviated against resistance.

Positive Sign

Pain over the lateral epicondyle.

Indicates

Lateral epicondylitis.

2. MILL'S TEST

Purpose

To assess lateral epicondylitis.

Procedure

- Patient sits with the elbow extended.
- Forearm pronated.
- Therapist passively flexes the wrist while maintaining elbow extension.

Positive Sign

Pain over the lateral epicondyle.

Indicates

Lateral epicondylitis.

3. MAUDSLEY'S TEST (MIDDLE FINGER TEST)

Purpose

To assess lateral epicondylitis, especially involvement of the Extensor Digitorum Communis (EDC).

Procedure

- Elbow extended.

- Forearm pronated.
- Patient resists extension of the middle finger.

Positive Sign

Pain over the lateral epicondyle.

Indicates

Lateral epicondylitis.

II. TEST FOR MEDIAL EPICONDYLITIS (GOLFER'S ELBOW)

4. GOLFER'S ELBOW TEST (MEDIAL EPICONDYLITIS TEST)

Purpose

To assess medial epicondylitis (Golfer's Elbow).

Procedure

- Patient sits with the elbow extended.
- Forearm supinated.
- Therapist passively extends the wrist and fingers while maintaining elbow extension.

Positive Sign

Pain over the medial epicondyle.

Indicates

Medial Epicondylitis (Golfer's Elbow)

III. NERVE COMPRESSION TEST

5. TINEL'S SIGN (CUBITAL TUNNEL)

Purpose

To assess ulnar nerve irritation or compression.

Procedure

- Slightly flex the elbow.
- Tap gently over the ulnar nerve behind the medial epicondyle.

Positive Sign

Tingling or electric shock sensation along the ring and little fingers.

Indicates

Cubital Tunnel Syndrome (Ulnar nerve entrapment).

IV. LIGAMENT STABILITY TESTS

6. VALGUS STRESS TEST

Purpose

To assess the Medial (Ulnar) Collateral Ligament (MCL/UCL).

Procedure

- Elbow slightly flexed (20–30°).
- Stabilize the humerus.
- Apply a valgus force to the forearm.

Positive Sign

Pain or excessive medial joint opening.

Indicates

Medial collateral ligament injury.

7. VARUS STRESS TEST

Purpose

To assess the Lateral Collateral Ligament (LCL).

Procedure

- Elbow slightly flexed (20–30°).
- Stabilize the humerus.
- Apply a varus force to the forearm.

Positive Sign

Pain or excessive lateral joint opening.

Indicates

Lateral collateral ligament injury.

★ REVISION TABLE – ELBOW SPECIAL TEST

Category	Test	Positive Sign	Indicates
Lateral Epicondylitis	Cozen's Test	Pain over lateral epicondyle	Tennis Elbow
	Mill's Test	Pain over lateral epicondyle	Tennis Elbow
	Maudsley's Test	Pain over lateral epicondyle	Tennis Elbow (EDC involvement)

Category	Test	Positive Sign	Indicates
Medial Epicondylitis	Golfer's Elbow Test	Pain over medial epicondyle	Golfer's Elbow
Nerve Compression	Tinel's Sign	Tingling in ring & little fingers	Cubital Tunnel Syndrome
Ligament Stability	Valgus Stress Test	Pain/laxity medially	MCL (UCL) injury
	Varus Stress Test	Pain/laxity laterally	LCL injury